

MEASURED · 167,870 POSTS · LAST 7 WEEKS

What actually makes residents comment?

Comments are the rarest — and most valuable — reaction on government pages. The data on what earns them surprised us.

1

+218%

Name the person.

Posts naming an officer, chief, mayor, or firefighter average 12.7 comments — vs 4.0 without. Residents reply to people, not departments.

With



Without



AVG COMMENTS PER POST

2

+117%

Mark the milestone.

Retirements, welcomes, anniversaries, congratulations: 9.3 comments on average. Communities show up to say goodbye and welcome.

With



Without



AVG COMMENTS PER POST

3

+77%

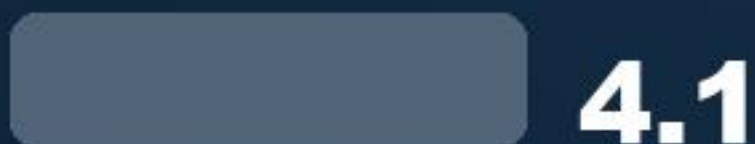
Say thank you.

Gratitude posts draw 7.2 comments on average — residents add their own thanks below yours.

With



Without



AVG COMMENTS PER POST

THE TWIST

Asking barely works.

“Tell us what you think” posts average 5.0 comments vs 4.5 for everything else — just +11%. You don't get comments by asking for them. You get them by putting people at the center of the post.

(We tested this on our own page too. Same result.)

THE PLAYBOOK

- ① Lead with a name and a face.
- ② Celebrate arrivals, milestones, farewells.
- ③ Thank people specifically, in public.
- ④ Save the “tell us below” for when it counts.

See which of your posts residents respond to — free:

govfeeds.com